A6 · Proposal and Grant Compliance Assistant

Participant guide: what to build, the ground rules, and what is in your pack

Synthetic data. Water Care, the Taps for Rights project, Nimbara, Sundara and every partner, person and figure in this pack are fictional. The documents follow real Global Affairs Canada (GAC) templates, and the 2018 funding call is a real public GAC document, but all project content is invented. **The information has been deliberately altered to include errors, gaps and inconsistencies so you can test whether your tool catches them.** Nothing here describes a real organization or project, and there are no real budget figures.

The situation

It is **30 June 2022**. Water Care is three years into **Taps for Rights**, a project funded by Global Affairs Canada that brings water into school and clinic toilets so women and girls can manage their periods with dignity, and uses that as an entry point to sexual and reproductive health and rights in two countries. Staff are juggling a funding call, a proposal, a contribution agreement, an indicator framework and progress reports, each with its own rules, dates and numbers. Some of them do not agree with each other.

Your task

Build an AI assistant that helps Water Care staff see what the funder requires, what is missing or inconsistent, and what is due, with **every finding pointing back to its source**. Pick one of the three tools below, connect two, or try all three. Depth beats breadth: one tool that works well scores higher than three that half work.

Tool	What it does	Start with
1. Proposal assistant	Reads the call and GAC guidance, checks the proposal against them, flags weak or missing evidence, suggests indicators and logic model fixes from approved sources, and finds similar past GAC projects in public data.	01 call, 02 proposal, 05 logic model and PMF, resource list
2. Grant compliance assistant	Reads the agreement, indicator framework, budget template and Year 3 report. Builds an obligations list and a reporting calendar, compares what was promised with what was reported, and shows a dashboard of issues that need attention on 30 June 2022.	03 agreement, 04 report, 05 and 06 workbooks
3. Funding radar (stretch)	Scans GAC and other Government of Canada (namely IDRC, ECCC) funding pages, plans and news for signals a water charity operating internationally should act on today (2026, not the 2022 scenario), and explains why each one matters.	Resource list, section C

Ground rules

- **Cite the source** of every finding: document, section or clause, and page.
- **Never invent** obligations, evidence, indicators or past results. If it is not in the documents, say so.
- **Flag ambiguity** instead of resolving it. When documents disagree, name the question and who should answer it (staff or GAC). Article 1.3 of the agreement says which document wins.
- **Track versions**: say which document and version a finding relies on (for example, which General Terms and Conditions apply).
- **People decide**. Your tool drafts and flags; Water Care staff approve. It never submits anything or certifies compliance.

What is in your pack

File	What it is
00 Start here (this guide)	The task, ground rules, resources and test questions.
01 Funding call (PDF)	GAC's 2018 call "Partnerships for Her Voice, Her Choice". A real public document, unchanged, with a cover page.
02 Preliminary proposal (PDF)	Water Care's April 2018 proposal on GAC's form. Use it for the proposal assistant.
03 Contribution agreement (PDF)	The consolidated agreement with GAC: articles, project description, financial terms, budget categories and reporting requirements.
04 Year 3 results report (PDF)	Annual Project Results Report for April 2021 to March 2022, dated 27 May 2022.
05 Logic model and PMF (Excel)	Approved outcomes, outputs, activities and indicators with baselines and targets.
06 Budget template (Excel)	GAC-style budget with categories, rules and typical GAC questions. No figures: create your own test data if you need numbers.

Resources

All links are public. They were checked on 14 October 2026.

A. GAC rules, templates and guidance

- Funding guidance hub
- How GAC assesses proposals nine criteria, five-level rating
- Results-based management how-to guide
- Results-based management tools logic model, PMF and risk templates; tip sheets on indicators
- Results reporting guide for implementers (2025) what each report must contain
- General Terms and Conditions, previous versions the agreement uses the version in force on its effective date
- General Terms and Conditions, current version
- Guidance on eligible costs
- Compliance 101 for development initiatives short videos on cost rules
- Gender equality toolkit

B. Past GAC-funded projects (for the research feature)

- Project Browser search and download GAC projects
- International assistance open data
- GAC data in IATI the international aid transparency standard
- Sector coding tables water and sanitation codes start with 140
- Grants and Contributions disclosure

C. Funding signals (for the funding radar)

- GAC funding opportunities: open and closed calls
- GAC 2026-27 Departmental Plan
- Report to Parliament on International Assistance 2024-25 (PDF)
- GAC news release example: International Development Week 2026 follow GAC news for new signals
- OECD Development Co-operation Profile: Canada
- Also consider sourcing IDRC, ECCC, and other relevant opportunities for Water Care.

You may also use WaterAid's Global and Canada Strategies and any other WaterAid materials to define parameters on best fit.

D. Indicators

- WHO/UNICEF Joint Monitoring Programme (JMP) standard water, sanitation and hygiene definitions

E. Assumptions for your cost estimate (illustrative, not Water Care data)

Staff time today, to compare with your tool: annual results report 15 to 20 staff days; semi-annual operations report 5 to 8 days; preliminary proposal 20 to 30 days; checking a report against the agreement 2 to 4 days; setting up a reporting calendar for a new agreement 1 to 2 days. Replace these with your own estimates and test them. Label any assumed change in proposal success or compliance risk as an assumption.

Test questions

Run your tool on these and report how many it answers correctly, with sources. Several have more than one right answer, or no single answer because the documents conflict: in those cases, the right answer is to flag the conflict and say who should resolve it. Judges have the answers.

1. On what date did the contribution agreement take effect, and why that date?
2. By what date must all project activities be completed, and when does the agreement expire?
3. What is GAC's maximum share of eligible direct costs, and does it include overhead?
4. What is Water Care's minimum contribution, and in what form (cash, in kind, or both)?
5. Does Water Care's minimum contribution meet the call's cost-share requirement?
6. What overhead rate applies, and to which costs?
7. Can Water Care move 25% of the travel budget line to goods without asking GAC?
8. When was the Year 3 annual results report due, and was it submitted on time?
9. When was the Year 4 annual work plan due?
10. When is the Disposal of Assets Plan due?
11. When is the final results and operations report due? Is the agreement consistent on this?
12. Which version of GAC's General Terms and Conditions applies to this agreement?
13. What must Water Care have from GAC before starting any construction?
14. What is the cap on subcontracting costs paid by GAC?
15. How must costs in foreign currencies be converted to Canadian dollars?
16. How many advance periods can be outstanding at once, and did Water Care stay within the rule?
17. What is the project's direct reach target, and do the figures in the agreement add up?
18. How many targeted health care facilities met indicator 1210.3 in Year 3, and what percentage is that?
19. Which indicator still has no target, and which indicator's target is below its baseline?
20. Was GAC informed of the change of youth engagement partner in the way the agreement requires?
21. Which parts of the proposal or project may not fit the call's rules on new construction?
22. Did any spending in Year 3 need GAC approval that had not been received?
23. Which claims in the proposal or the Year 3 report have no supporting evidence?
24. Which documents disagree about the reporting period or due dates of the Year 3 report?
25. As of 30 June 2022, what are the three most urgent issues for Water Care to act on, and why?